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PMM Portfolio Projects

5 Projects. Step by Step. Exactly What to Build.

This document contains every project Ujjwal needs to build for a PMM career. For each project: what it is, why it matters to recruiters, exact step-by-step instructions, tools required, time needed, expected results, and mistakes to avoid.

01	Competitive Analysis Document	September 2026
02	Positioning & Messaging Framework	October 2026
03	Product Teardown — PMM Lens	November 2026
04	Go-To-Market Launch Plan	Dec 2026–Jan 2027
05	Customer Persona + ICP Research	February 2027

A deep, structured analysis of 4-5 competitors in one product category. Shows you can map a market, identify positioning gaps, and think strategically about where a product should play.

Time Required 3–4 weeks (1 hr/day)	Difficulty Medium Research-heavy	Math Required Zero	Output Format Notion doc + Medium article	When to Apply Month 1 September
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WHY THIS PROJECT MATTERS

Competitive analysis is the first thing a PMM is asked to do in most companies. When a recruiter at Razorpay, CRED, or any funded startup sees this in your portfolio, they do not need to imagine whether you can do the job — they can see you already did it. Most MBA freshers applying for PMM roles have zero proof they know what competitive intelligence means. This project makes you immediately different.

PICK YOUR CATEGORY — Choose ONE

CATEGORY	PRODUCTS TO ANALYZE	WHY IT WORKS
Indian Fintech Apps	Zerodha, Groww, Upstox, Angel One, INDmoney	Large user base, active Reddit community for customer voice data
EdTech Platforms	PhysicsWallah, Unacademy, Vedantu, Byju's, Toppr	Easy to understand the student customer — strong ICP insight available
Project Mgmt Tools	Notion, Asana, Monday, Linear, Trello	B2B SaaS — directly relevant for remote international PMM roles
HR Tech India	Zoho People, Keka, DarwinBox, greyHR, HRDroid	Underwritten category — your analysis will stand out more

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

STEP 1

Collect Positioning Data (Week 1)

For each competitor, visit: their homepage — screenshot the headline and subheadline. Their About page — copy their mission statement. Their pricing page — note the tier names and what language they use. Their LinkedIn description. Run a search for their name + 'ad' on Meta Ads Library (free tool at facebook.com/ads/library) to see their active ads. Create a folder per competitor. Save everything.

STEP 2

Gather Customer Voice Data (Week 1-2)

Go to G2.com and Capterra.com. Search each product. Read 15-20 reviews per product. Copy exact phrases from 'What do you like most' and 'What do you dislike' sections. Search Reddit for each product name — find threads where users describe their experience in their own words. Check App Store reviews if it is a mobile product. You are collecting the exact language real customers use to describe value and pain.

STEP 3

Map Each Competitor (Week 2)

For every competitor, fill in this structure: (1) Who are they targeting — be specific, not 'businesses' but 'early-stage founders with a 5-person team.' (2) Their core positioning in one sentence — X is for Y who wants Z. (3) Their 3 most repeated key messages — what do they say constantly across ads, homepage, and social. (4) Pricing strategy — premium, freemium, or competitive. (5) Biggest strength from customer reviews. (6) Biggest complaint from customer reviews. (7) What type of customer leaves them and why.

**STEP
4****Write Your Synthesis (Week 3)**

After mapping all competitors, write a 2-page analysis answering: Where is the white space in this market — which customer is nobody talking to clearly? Which competitor has the strongest positioning and why — what makes it sharp? Which has the weakest and why — where is the confusion? If you were launching a new product in this category, what would you position it as to avoid competing head-on?

**STEP
5****Build the Document and Publish (Week 4)**

Create a Notion document with: a summary comparison table at the top (one row per competitor, columns for target customer, positioning, key message, strength, weakness), then detailed analysis for each competitor below, then your synthesis at the end. Design it cleanly — use headers, bold key phrases, and add screenshots where relevant. Export as PDF. Then write a shorter 800-word version of just your synthesis and publish on Medium with a title like: 'I analyzed 5 Indian fintech apps — here is who is winning the positioning battle and why.'

TOOLS REQUIRED — ALL FREE

TOOL	PURPOSE	LINK
G2.com	Customer reviews and voice data	g2.com — no signup needed
Capterra.com	B2B software reviews	capterra.com — no signup needed
Meta Ads Library	See any company's active ads for free	facebook.com/ads/library
Reddit	Unfiltered customer opinions and complaints	reddit.com — search product name
Notion	Build and publish your document	notion.so — free account
Medium	Publish your shortened article version	medium.com — free account
SimilarWeb (free tier)	Basic traffic data for each competitor	similarweb.com

EXPECTED RESULTS

WHAT RECRUITERS SEE	WHAT IT DEMONSTRATES
A structured comparison table showing 5 competitors mapped across the same criteria	You can organize complex market information — core analyst skill
Specific customer language pulled from real reviews — not paraphrased	You understand voice-of-customer research — essential PMM skill
A clear identification of a white space or positioning gap	You can think strategically, not just descriptively
A publishable Medium article with your synthesis	You can communicate complex ideas clearly to an audience
A Notion portfolio piece that you send with every application	You have proof of PMM capability before anyone interviews you

MISTAKES TO AVOID

COMMON MISTAKE	WHY IT HURTS	FIX
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Listing features instead of positioning	Features are what the product does. Positioning is why a customer should choose it. PMM is about positioning, not features.	For each competitor, ask: 'What feeling or outcome are they promising?' not 'What can it do?'
Picking too broad a category	'SaaS tools' is not a category. 'Indian HR software for companies with 50-200 employees' is.	Your 5 competitors must be directly competing with each other for the same customer.
Describing without concluding	A document that describes 5 companies with no synthesis is a Wikipedia article, not analysis.	Your synthesis must have a clear recommendation: 'If I were launching in this space, I would position as X because...'

Apply April Dunford's positioning canvas to a real product. Then write the messaging that flows from that positioning. This is the intellectual core of PMM — deciding how a product should be positioned, then writing what that sounds like.

Time Required
3 weeks (1 hr/day)

Difficulty
Medium-High
Thinking-heavy

Math Required
Zero

Output Format
Notion canvas +
Medium article

When to Build
Month 2 October

BEFORE YOU START — READ THIS

Read Part 2 of 'Obviously Awesome' by April Dunford before doing anything else in this project. Her 5-component positioning canvas is the framework you will apply. Without reading it, you will not understand what positioning actually means. The book is 200 pages. Part 2 is about 60 pages. Read it in one weekend.

THE POSITIONING CANVAS — 5 COMPONENTS

COMPONENT	WHAT IT MEANS	EXAMPLE (BAD)	EXAMPLE (GOOD)
1. Competitive Alternatives	What would customers use if this product didn't exist?	Other products didn't exist	Excel spreadsheets + email threads + Slack messages
2. Unique Attributes	What does this product have that all alternatives genuinely lack?	It's all the same	Realtime sync across 50 users with zero refresh lag
3. Value (So What?)	Why do those unique attributes matter to the customer?	Saves time	Team decisions happen in hours not days — faster launches
4. Target Customer	Who gets the most value from these unique attributes?	Businesses	Series A SaaS startups with remote engineering teams of 8-25 people
5. Market Category	What category does this product belong to — and is that the right one?	Product tool	Remote team operating system (not just project management)

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

STEP 1

Pick Your Product (Day 1)

Choose a mid-size Indian SaaS or funded startup. Good options: LeadSquared, Zoho (any single product like Zoho CRM or Zoho Books), RazorpayX, Instamojo, Freshdesk, Clevertap, or WebEngage. Avoid massive companies like Salesforce — too complex to analyse. You want a product where you can read everything publicly available in 1 week and form a genuine view.

STEP 2	Research the Product Deeply (Week 1) Read everything publicly available: their full website, every page. Their blog — last 10 articles. Their customer case studies — these are gold. Any founder or marketing leader interviews on YouTube or podcasts. Their LinkedIn company page and what their marketing team posts. G2 reviews — specifically what customers say they chose this over. App Store reviews. Any conference talks on YouTube. You want to understand: who is actually using this, what problem it solves for them, and what language they use to describe the value.
STEP 3	Fill In Their Current Positioning Canvas (Week 1-2) Apply all 5 components to how they currently position themselves. Be as specific as possible. Pull direct evidence from their website and reviews. Do not summarise — quote their actual language where possible.
STEP 4	Find the Gap (Week 2) Ask yourself: Is their target customer too broad? Is their market category wrong? Is their unique attribute actually unique or do 3 competitors also claim it? Do their key messages match what customers actually say they value in reviews? Find ONE specific thing that is unclear, weak, or misaligned in their current positioning.
STEP 5	Write the Repositioned Canvas + New Messaging (Week 2-3) Write an alternative or sharpened positioning using the same 5-component canvas. Then write what flows from it: a new homepage headline (clear, specific, outcome-focused), 3 key messages that support the positioning (each in one sentence), a one-sentence positioning statement in the format: For [specific target customer] who [specific need], [product] is the [market category] that [unique value]. Unlike [alternatives], [product] [key differentiator].
STEP 6	Write the Full Analysis and Publish (Week 3) Structure: (1) How they currently position themselves — evidence from website and reviews. (2) What customers actually say they value — evidence from G2 and Reddit. (3) The gap you found between their messaging and customer perception. (4) Your repositioned canvas — all 5 components filled in. (5) The new messaging — headline, 3 key messages, positioning statement. (6) Why you believe this is stronger. Write 1500-2000 words. Publish on Medium. Add the Notion canvas as a visual in your portfolio.

EXPECTED RESULTS

WHAT RECRUITERS SEE	WHAT IT DEMONSTRATES
A filled positioning canvas with evidence for every component	You understand the intellectual framework that drives PMM work
A clearly identified positioning gap with evidence	You can think critically, not just descriptively
A repositioned version with new headline and 3 key messages	You can do the core creative work of a PMM — write positioning
A Medium article explaining your thinking	You can write clearly and communicate strategic ideas

COMMON MISTAKE	WHY IT HURTS	FIX
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Saying 'their positioning is weak' without evidence	Opinions without evidence are not analysis.	Every claim must reference something: a review, a website quote, a competitor comparison.
Making the new messaging too clever	PMM messaging that is clever but unclear fails. Clarity wins.	Test your headline: would a stranger understand what the product does in 5 seconds?
Skipping the current-state canvas	Jumping straight to recommendations without mapping the current state shows you cannot analyse before prescribing.	Fill in their existing positioning fully before writing your alternative.

A deep teardown of one product's entire go-to-market presence — website, ads, emails, content, pricing page — analysed through a PMM lens. Not 'where do users drop off' (that is PM). But 'how is this product marketed, positioned, and sold — and what would you change?'

Time Required 3–4 weeks (2 wks observe, 1-2 wks write)	Difficulty Medium Observation + writing heavy	Math Required Zero	Output Format Medium article (main piece) + Notion	When to Build Month 3 November
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PICK YOUR PRODUCT — INTERNATIONAL B2B SAAS

Use an international product for this one — specifically a B2B SaaS. Most remote international PMM roles are at B2B SaaS companies. Choosing one shows you understand their world.

PRODUCT	WHY IT WORKS FOR THIS PROJECT
Notion	Massive community. Excellent content marketing to analyse. Clear positioning evolution over time.
Loom	Simple product with sophisticated PMM. Their messaging around 'async video' is a masterclass.
Calendly	Transformed from a scheduling tool to a 'revenue acceleration' platform — positioning pivot to analyse.
Typeform	Beautiful product with strong brand voice. Good for messaging analysis.
Hotjar	Analytics tool targeting non-technical users. Interesting positioning challenge.
Intercom	Complex product with multiple buyer personas. Richer analysis opportunity.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

STEP 1

Sign Up and Observe for 2 Full Weeks (Weeks 1-2)

Sign up for their free tier on Day 1. Then do nothing else for 2 weeks except observe. Screenshot every onboarding email you receive — the subject line, the first line, the call to action, and the timing. Screenshot their homepage, pricing page, about page, and any popup or banner that appears. Note: what do they want you to do first?

STEP 2

Audit Their Advertising (Week 1)

Go to Meta Ads Library ([facebook.com/ads/library](https://www.facebook.com/ads/library)). Search the company name. Look at their active ads. Screenshot 5-10 of them. Ask: what is the hook? Who is the ad clearly speaking to? What emotion does it lead with? Does this match what their website says? Then search YouTube for 'product name review' or 'product name tutorial' — these creator videos show what users actually find valuable versus what the company emphasizes.

STEP 3

Audit Their Content (Week 2)

Read their last 10 blog posts. What topics do they write about most? Who are these articles written for? What keywords do they target? Check their LinkedIn — what do they post and what gets engagement? Check if they have a podcast, webinar series, or YouTube channel. What is the consistent theme across all content?

**STEP
4****Answer the PMM Questions (Week 2-3)**

Now write answers to: (1) Who are they clearly targeting — and who are they ignoring? (2) What is their positioning — even if unstated? (3) Is their homepage headline clear? Would a stranger understand the product in 5 seconds? (4) Does their ad messaging match their website messaging? (5) What emotion or outcome does their marketing lead with? (6) What does the onboarding email sequence prioritize — features, value, or conversion? (7) Is the pricing page designed to sell or to confuse? (8) What is one thing they do brilliantly? What is one specific thing they do poorly?

**STEP
5****Write and Publish the Teardown (Week 3-4)**

Structure: (1) One-paragraph overview — what the product is and who it is for. (2) Homepage analysis — annotated screenshot, what works, what does not. (3) Ad analysis — what their advertising tells you about their strategy. (4) Content strategy — what they publish and who it is for. (5) Onboarding email sequence — screenshot each email, analyse the sequence logic. (6) Pricing page — is it clear? Does it help or hinder conversion? (7) One thing they do brilliantly — with specific evidence. (8) One thing you would change — with specific reasoning. Write 2000-2500 words. Include annotated screenshots. Publish on Medium. This is your most publishable project — it will get the most readers.

EXPECTED RESULTS

WHAT RECRUITERS SEE	WHAT IT DEMONSTRATES
Annotated screenshots of homepage, ads, and emails	You conducted structured primary research, not just desk research
A clear answer to 'what emotion does their marketing lead with?'	You understand that marketing is about feeling, not just information
A specific, evidence-based 'one thing I would change'	You can form and defend a strategic recommendation
A 2000+ word Medium article with visual evidence	You can produce PMM-quality written work at depth

COMMON MISTAKE	WHY IT HURTS	FIX
Reviewing the product as a user, not as a marketer	'The UI is clean' is user feedback. PMM teardowns analyse marketing decisions.	Always ask 'Why did they make this marketing decision?' not 'Do I like this product?'
Describing instead of analysing	'Their homepage has a headline and a CTA' is description. PMM requires analysis.	For every observation, add: 'This works/fails because...' and 'I would change this by...'

Your most impressive project. A complete, realistic GTM plan for a simulated product launch. This is what senior PMMs produce every quarter. Building one as a fresher shows you understand the full PMM job, not just one skill.

Time Required	Difficulty	Math Required	Output Format	When to Build
4–5 weeks (1 hr/day)	High Most complex piece	Minimal Only in metrics	Notion document (internal style)	Month 4-5 Dec–Jan

PICK YOUR LAUNCH SCENARIO — Choose ONE

SCENARIO	WHY IT WORKS
Zerodha launches a mutual fund advisory tool for first-time investors	Specific customer, specific geography, clear problem — rich ICP to write about
Notion launches a product specifically for Indian college students	Student as a customer personally — strongest ICP insight
A fintech startup launches a business credit card for freelancers and solopreneurs in India	Growing and underserved customer, clear pain point around cash flow
Figma launches a simplified design tool for marketing teams	Real positioning: designers Figma built for designers, now targeting non-designers

EXACT DOCUMENT STRUCTURE — Build It Section by Section

STEP 1

Section 1: Market Context (half a page)

What is the market opportunity? Pull one or two real data points from a public report (search '[market] India 2026 report' — many are freely summarised in news articles). Who is currently underserved in this space and why? What is the timing rationale — why does this launch make sense NOW rather than 2 years ago?

STEP 2

Section 2: Target Customer / ICP (half a page)

Be extremely specific. Not 'young professionals' — '26-34 year old freelance graphic designers in Mumbai and Pune earning Rs.80,000-1,50,000 per month who currently send invoices via WhatsApp and track income in a notebook.' Then write one paragraph in FIRST PERSON as that customer: 'I am Priya. I have 12 clients. Every month I chase 4 of them for payment...' This paragraph is the most powerful thing in your GTM plan.

STEP 3

Section 3: Positioning and Messaging (half a page)

Write one positioning statement using this format: For [specific customer] who [specific need], [product] is the [category] that [unique value]. Unlike [alternatives], [product] [key differentiator]. Then write 3 key messages — one sentence each. Then write the hero headline for the launch campaign. Everything must connect directly to what your ICP cares about.

STEP 4

Section 4: Launch Channels (one page)

Choose 3-4 channels. For each one: why does this channel reach your specific ICP (not 'because everyone is on Instagram' — specific reasoning), what type of content or ad, what is the call to action, and what does success look like in numbers. Good channels to consider: LinkedIn (B2B), Instagram/YouTube Shorts (B2C), community partnerships (relevant Reddit, Discord, Slack communities), influencer/creator partnerships (niche creators who reach your ICP), PR (specific publications your ICP reads).

**STEP
5****Section 5: Launch Timeline (half a page)**

Three phases: Pre-launch (4 weeks before) — build waitlist, warm up audience, create anticipation. Launch week — full channel activation, press, community outreach. Post-launch (first 30 days) — convert interest to active users, gather feedback, run first retention activities. For each phase, list 3-4 specific activities.

**STEP
6****Section 6: Success Metrics (half a page)**

Choose exactly 3 metrics. Make them specific and measurable. Not 'increase awareness' — '2,000 waitlist signups in the 3 weeks before launch.' Not 'drive conversions' — '12% trial-to-paid conversion rate in the first 60 days.' Not 'build community' — '500 members in the launch Discord server by end of month 1.' For each metric, write one sentence explaining why THIS metric, not another.

EXPECTED RESULTS

WHAT RECRUITERS SEE	WHAT IT DEMONSTRATES
A complete GTM document that looks like real internal PMM work	You understand the full scope of a PMM's job, not just one skill area
A specific ICP written in first person	You can empathize with customers — the most critical PMM ability
Channel selection with clear reasoning for each choice	You can make strategic trade-offs, not just list options
3 specific, measurable success metrics	You think in outcomes, not activities — this is what companies want

COMMON MISTAKE	WHY IT HURTS	FIX
Choosing every channel available	Listing 8 channels with no trade-off reasoning shows no strategic thinking.	Choose 3-4 channels max. Explain explicitly why you chose these and not the others.
Vague metrics	'Increase brand awareness' is not a metric. It tells a recruiter you do not know how GTM performance is actually measured.	Every metric must have a number, a timeframe, and one sentence explaining why that metric.
Generic ICP	'Millennials who use smartphones' could describe 400 million people.	Your ICP must be specific enough that you could find 100 of them on LinkedIn using search filters.

A detailed buyer persona document built entirely from public data — 50+ real user data points from reviews, Reddit, LinkedIn, and app stores. Shows you can do structured customer research without access to internal company data.

Time Required 3 weeks (1 hr/day)	Difficulty Medium Research + writing	Math Required Zero	Output Format Notion persona cards + Medium	When to Build Month 6 February
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WHERE TO COLLECT DATA — FREE SOURCES

SOURCE	WHAT TO COLLECT	HOW TO USE IT
G2.com / Capterra	30+ reviews per product. Copy exact phrasing from "what I like" and "what I don't like" sections.	Builds your understanding of most and what language is like. Use their exact words.
Reddit	Find the subreddit for the product or category. Read threads where users describe why they switched products.	Reveals real pain points and why users switch products.
LinkedIn	Search people who list the product in their bio. Build a demographic of professions, industries, and company sizes.	Builds the demographic of your persona.
App Store / Play Store	Read 20+ reviews, especially 3-star reviews.	Shows what casual users value versus what power users value — often very different.
YouTube comments	Find 'product review' or 'vs alternative' videos. Read top comments.	People reading these sections are highly specific about their use case and situation.
Twitter / X	Search the product name. Look for complaints and praise.	Find what triggers frustration and what creates loyalty.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

STEP 1

Choose a Product with an Active Community (Day 1)

Best choices: Zerodha (very active on Reddit r/IndiaInvestments and Twitter), Notion (massive global community), any popular Indian D2C brand (boAt, Mama Earth, Minimalist), or a B2B tool with 50+ G2 reviews. The more reviews and community discussion exists, the richer your data will be.

STEP 2

Collect 50+ Data Points Across All Sources (Week 1-2)

Use a simple Notion table to log every data point: source, exact quote or observation, and what it tells you about the customer. Do not paraphrase — copy exact language. This is your raw research. You need at least 50 distinct data points across the sources listed above before you begin writing anything.

STEP 3

Find Two Distinct Patterns (Week 2)

After collecting data, look for two clearly different types of users emerging. They might differ by: company size (solo freelancer vs 10-person team), usage intensity (daily power user vs occasional user), goal (efficiency vs creativity vs cost saving), or experience level (beginner vs expert). These two patterns become your two personas.

STEP 4

Build Two Persona Cards (Week 2-3)

For each persona, write: A name and a stock photo (use Unsplash.com — free). A job title and company type. Their primary goal — what are they trying to achieve? Their main frustration — what keeps them from achieving it? The specific pain this product solves for them. What they were using before this product. What made them switch. Three direct quotes pulled verbatim from real reviews that capture their voice. Do not invent quotes — use only real ones you collected.

**STEP
5****Write the ICP Definition (Week 3)**

An ICP (Ideal Customer Profile) is more strategic than a persona. It answers: which type of company or customer gets the most value, churns the least, and refers others most? Looking at your two personas and all your data, write a 1-page ICP definition covering: company size and type, industry, budget range, buying trigger (what event causes them to start looking for this solution), buying process (who decides, how long it takes), and why they stay long-term.

**STEP
6****Publish the Research (Week 3)**

Build persona cards in Notion — clean, visual, designed with sections and a stock photo. Then write a Medium article summarising what you found: 'I spent 3 weeks reading 50+ reviews so you don't have to — here is what [product] users actually care about.' The article focuses on the 3 most surprising things you found — what customers value that the company does not emphasise enough, what frustrates customers that is never mentioned in marketing, and the one thing that makes customers stay for years.

EXPECTED RESULTS

WHAT RECRUITERS SEE	WHAT IT DEMONSTRATES
50+ logged data points from real public sources	You conduct structured primary research — rarer than people think
Two distinct persona cards with real verbatim quotes	You use actual customer voice, not assumptions — core PMM discipline
A 1-page ICP definition that is specific and evidence-based	You think strategically about who the right customer is, not just who the user is
A Medium article revealing surprising findings	You can turn research into insight — the thing that separates good PMMs from great ones

COMMON MISTAKE	WHY IT HURTS	FIX
Creating fictional personas from imagination	A persona built from assumptions about users is marketing fiction, not customer research.	Every statement in your persona must trace back to a real data point you collected.
Making both personas too similar	If your two personas are almost identical, you have not found two distinct patterns.	Your two personas should have genuinely different goals, situations, or behaviours.
Confusing persona with ICP	A persona is who uses the product. An ICP is who the company should focus on.	Write both separately. A user persona can be outside the ICP — that is a real insight.

Your Complete PMM Portfolio at Graduation

#	PROJECT	MONTH	FORMAT	PRIMARY SKILL DEMONSTRATED
01	Competitive Analysis Document	Sep 2026	Notion + Medium	Competitive intelligence, market thinking
02	Positioning & Messaging Framework	Oct 2026	Medium + Notion canvas	Core PMM craft — positioning and messaging
03	Product Teardown — PMM Lens	Nov 2026	Medium (main) + Notion	GTM analysis, marketing judgement
04	Go-To-Market Launch Plan	Dec–Jan	Notion doc (PDF export)	Full PMM scope — ICP, channels, metrics, timeline
05	Customer Persona + ICP Research	Feb 2027	Notion cards + Medium	Customer research, voice-of-customer, ICP thinking
HUB	Notion Portfolio Hub — links all 5	Ongoing	Notion (shared link)	Professional presentation — sent with every application

Writing Quality — The One Skill That Makes or Breaks All Five Projects

PMM is the most writing-intensive role in any product company. Every project above will be judged on how well it is written before the quality of the thinking is even evaluated. Bad writing makes good ideas invisible. Good writing makes average ideas look sharp. This is not optional — it is the foundation.

The Daily Writing Habit — Start This Week

Every day, read ONE article from any of these sources: First Round Review (firstround.com/review), Lenny's Newsletter (lennyrachitsky.com), Product Marketing Alliance blog (productmarketingalliance.com/blog), or HBR (hbr.org — many free articles). Read it not for the content but for HOW it is written. Notice: sentence length. When they use examples. How they open each section. What they never include (filler, repetition, throat-clearing). Then write ONE paragraph about anything using the same discipline. Five sentences. Precise. No waste. This habit compounded over 10 months will make your portfolio writing noticeably better than every other MBA fresher applying for the same roles.

The Rules That Separate PMM Writing from MBA Writing

Lead with the insight, not the context

Wrong: 'In order to understand the competitive landscape, I conducted a detailed ' analysis of five companies in the Indian fintech space...'

Right: 'Zerodha is winning the positioning battle — and their competitors do not ' seem to know why yet. Here is what I found.'

Use specific numbers and names instead of vague descriptions

Wrong: 'Many users reported being frustrated with the onboarding experience.'

Right: '11 of the 18 G2 reviews I read mentioned the same onboarding step as confusing — the moment they are asked to connect their bank account before seeing any value.'

One idea per paragraph

Each paragraph should have one point, evidence for that point, and why it matters. If a paragraph is doing three things, split it into three paragraphs.

Cut the last sentence of every paragraph you write

The last sentence is almost always a summary of what you just said. The reader does not need to be told what they just read. Delete it.

Never start with 'In this article...' or 'This document will...'

Start with the thing itself. The reader chose to read — they do not need a menu.

If you complete all 5 projects with genuine depth, publish all of them, and build your Notion portfolio hub — you will have more demonstrated PMM capability than most candidates with 1-2 years of experience. Your college name will not be the first thing a recruiter notices. Your work will be. That is the entire point of building this portfolio.

Document prepared August 2026. All tools and resources listed are free unless explicitly stated otherwise. Projects are designed for 3 hours/day availability. Update your Notion portfolio hub after completing each piece.